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Persuasive Strategies Used in Literature

Memories are a crucial part of humans, even if they aren't physical. Imagine losing them over time; what would you be like without them? In the article *Does Anyone Collect Old Emails?* the author addresses how people lose their memories due to storing everything digitally. The author captivates the reader by his point and uses several persuasive techniques to keep them entertained and reading. Peter Funt, the author, wrote this paper using pathos and ethos to show the reader how, compared to later generations where all their pictures were physical, the newer generations store everything digitally, making it easier to lose or forget.

Peter Funt uses ethos to convince the reader of his point in several ways, but one way is how he wrote about the digital age and how people's memories get stored and eventually forgotten. As page one states, "My two kids, now in their 20's, have mostly digital keepsakes. Increasingly, they rely on Facebook and the cloud to store memories. Their letters from college, sent by email, are long gone. Many photos, never printed, have disappeared" (Funt 1). Over time, almost everything stored digitally can be lost in the foggy dew, even if those pictures are long-lost treasures to be sook. He demonstrates ethos by using his experience with his kids and how they don't remember most of their memories that were stored digitally. Funt also states,

“After my father’s death, in 1999, I saved a folder of handwritten condolence letters from his friends and colleagues. Rereading them once or twice a year, I am transported back to times I miss so much. Of course, I received many emails about Dad as well- but I wouldn’t begin to know how or where to find them” (1). As a person who used to collect keepsakes, he can remember them with more strength than sailors hauling treasures back to shore with ease. This is another example of how Funt displays ethos in his paper, as he uses his experience with physical versus digital keepsakes and how he remembers his physical ones but can’t even remember where or how to find his digital ones.

Now, alongside ethos, Peter Funt uses pathos to showcase his case and persuade people to listen to and believe him. This is demonstrated through his quotes from psychologists and scientists. As stated by Funt, “After my father’s death, in 1999, I saved a folder of handwritten condolence letters from his friends and colleagues. Rereading them once or twice a year, I am transported back to times I miss so much. Of course, I received many emails about Dad as well — but I wouldn’t begin to know how or where to find them.” (2). Funt describes his melancholy from after his father died and talks about how he reread the physical letters he received but couldn’t find any of the emails he got. This is a key example of how Funt uses pathos to persuade and draw in the readers, as he uses his dolefulness after his father died to affect the reader's emotions, then ties it straight into his point. Funt also states, “Their letters from college, sent by email, are long gone. Many photos, never printed, have disappeared. I worry that for them, personal history already doesn’t reach back as far as it should” (Funt 2). Funt speaks of his uncertainty for his children and their personal history. This is another example of Funt using pathos to persuade his readers by providing an emotional connection to his story about his kids

and how far back their personal history dates by speaking of his worry and uncertainty that it may not go back very far.

When it comes down to memories, people typically remember them through physical keepsakes rather than digital ones. In his article, Peter Funt persuades his audience of this fact by using ethos and pathos. Think about it: if your digital memories became physical ones, how much more would you remember and appreciate how far your life has come?